

Hormone Therapy

Patient Education Handout

Women's Health Program · KORB Health Group · For Patient Reference

This handout is for educational reference only. It is not medical advice. Always follow your prescription label and your KORB provider's guidance. If your label differs from anything here, follow your label and contact KORB.

Using Your Cream

Your cream comes in a pump dispenser measured in clicks. One click is a fixed amount, so your prescription tells you how many clicks to use rather than asking you to judge it by eye.

- Apply to **hairless, thin skin**: the inner thigh, the back of the upper arm, the forearm, or as directed.
- Rotate where you apply it rather than using the same spot daily.
- **Let it dry completely before your skin touches anyone else's.**
- Wash your hands thoroughly afterward.
- Apply at roughly the same time each day.

Hormone cream transfers by skin contact. If it has not fully dried, it can rub off onto a partner, a child, or a pet, and it will affect them. This is the single most important handling rule. Let it dry, cover the area if you can, and wash your hands every time.

Using Your Patch

- Apply to the lower abdomen or the upper buttock, on clean dry skin.
- Do not apply to the breasts.
- Rotate the site with each new patch.
- If a patch loosens, press it back down. If it will not stay, replace it and carry on with your usual schedule.

Taking Your Progesterone

- **Take it at night.** It commonly causes drowsiness, which is useful at bedtime and unhelpful at 8am.
- If you still have periods, you will likely take it 21 days on and 7 days off. Your provider will confirm.
- If your periods have stopped, you will most likely take it every day.
- If you miss a dose, take it when you remember unless it is nearly the next one. Do not double up.

Tell your provider if you have a peanut allergy. Some progesterone capsules contain peanut oil and a different product must be used.

What to Expect

Hot flashes and night sweats often improve first, sometimes within a few weeks. Sleep and mood usually follow. Vaginal dryness and libido tend to take longer, often a few months.

Some irregular spotting in the first months is common, particularly when starting or changing a dose. It usually settles. Bleeding that is heavy, persistent, or starts after a long stretch without any should always be reported.

Side Effects

What you may notice	What to do
Breast tenderness or swelling	Common early on. Tell your provider if it persists.
Headache, nausea, or bloating	Common at first. Tell your provider if it does not settle.
Mood changes	Report these. Your dose may need adjusting.
Spotting or changes in bleeding	Common early. Report anything heavy, persistent, or new after a long gap.
Acne or oilier skin (testosterone)	Tell your provider. Often dose-related.
Extra facial or body hair (testosterone)	Tell your provider promptly.
Deepening of your voice (testosterone)	Report this immediately. It can be permanent if not addressed.

Seek emergency care right away for: chest pain, trouble breathing, coughing up blood, sudden weakness or numbness on one side, trouble speaking, sudden severe headache, vision changes, or swelling, pain, or redness in one leg. These can signal a clot or stroke. Do not wait to hear back from KORB.

Tell Your Provider Before Continuing

- Any new diagnosis of cancer, particularly breast or uterine
- A blood clot, stroke, or heart attack
- Unexplained vaginal bleeding
- New or worsening migraines, especially with visual aura
- Gallbladder problems
- Pregnancy, or if you think you might be pregnant
- Any new medication, or planned surgery

Storage

- Store at room temperature, away from heat and direct sunlight, unless your label says otherwise.
- Keep creams and capsules out of reach of children and pets.
- Do not transfer your cream into another container. The pump is what measures your dose.

When to Contact KORB and When to Seek Emergency Care

Contact KORB Operations

- Questions about timing, storage, or administration

Email: info@korbhealth.com
Phone: +1 (888) 959-7299
Hours: Mon–Fri, 9 AM–6 PM CT

Patient Portal — Message Your Provider

- Mild but persistent side effects
- Questions about whether to continue therapy
- Questions about application, timing, or side effects

Seek Emergency Care Immediately

- Trouble breathing or throat / face swelling
- Severe rash or widespread hives
- Chest pain or fainting
- Severe or rapidly worsening symptoms
- Confusion or severe weakness
- Any symptom that feels urgent or unsafe

The Patient Portal is your only HIPAA-compliant way to message your provider directly — providers check portal messages once per day on clinic days. Phone and email are not appropriate for emergencies. When in doubt, go to urgent care or the emergency room.

Key Reminders

- Let cream dry fully before skin contact with anyone else, and wash your hands.
- Apply cream to hairless thin skin and rotate the site.
- Take progesterone at night.
- If you have a uterus, never take estrogen without progesterone.
- Report voice deepening immediately. It can be permanent.
- Report bleeding that is heavy, persistent, or new after a long gap.
- Your dose is guided by your symptoms, so tell us what has and has not improved.